

GemBreak — Blender Animator Briefs: Watch Reveal Animations

Compiled 2026-07-29. Two ready-to-hand briefs for a Blender artist. Prompt A = the signature GemBreak mystery-pack watch reveal (elevated version of the IcyBox-style opening — dopamine-engineered, replayable). Prompt B = the separate "crystal case shatter" concept. Note: the reference video couldn't be decoded in this environment, so Prompt A is built from the mystery-pack reveal format itself, pushed to be more impressive/impactful.

The psychology to engineer (both briefs obey this)

A reveal creates a "core memory you want to replay" by hitting these beats in order:

1. **Anticipation** — quiet, slow, tension building (silence before the drop).
 2. **Escalation in stages** — never one beat; build → build → BREAK (dopamine loves the staircase).
 3. **A fake-out / near-miss** — a half-second where it looks ordinary, then it isn't.
 4. **The HIT** — sudden multi-sensory payoff (light burst + bass + particles) on one frame.
 5. **Rarity signal** — the reward's tier is unmistakable (color, aura, scale).
 6. **Savor** — slow-motion + a clean hero shot lingered on (let them breathe it in).
 7. **Loopable resolution** — ends where it could restart (rewatch value).
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PROMPT A — "GemBreak Signature Watch Reveal" (hand this to the Blender artist)

Create a **~7–9 second, 9:16 vertical (1080×1920), 60fps** cinematic product-reveal animation in Blender (Cycles for caustics/realism; Eevee Next acceptable for speed). A premium mystery "gem pack" floats in a dark, moody void and violently reveals a luxury watch. The feel: ****Apple-keynote polish meets a slot-machine jackpot**** — restrained, then explosive.

Scene & staging

- Environment: near-black studio void, subtle radial gradient, faint volumetric haze (god-rays later).
- Hero object at start: a **faceted gemstone/crystal "pack"** (GemBreak's motif) suspended center-frame, slowly rotating, catching light on its edges. Inside, a watch is dimly visible through the refraction.
- Ground: a subtle reflective floor (soft reflection, not a mirror) for grounding + light bounce.

Beat sheet (with frame timing @ 60fps)

- **0.0–2.0s (Anticipation):** camera slow dolly-in on the rotating gem; ambient hum; a single rim light traces the facets; everything quiet and premium. A faint heartbeat-like pulse of inner light (tease).
- **2.0–3.0s (Escalation):** the gem starts to **vibrate/shudder**, inner light intensifies in pulses (each pulse brighter), micro-cracks of light appear along the facets, dust particles lift off. Camera pushes closer, slight handheld shake added.
- **3.0–3.3s (Fake-out):** everything **freezes and dims for ~8 frames** — dead silence, near-black. (The pause is the dopamine setup — do not skip it.)
- **3.3s (THE HIT — one frame):** the gem **detonates** — a white-hot light burst fills frame, shards + energy particles explode outward with heavy **motion blur**, a shockwave ring distorts the haze. This is the bass-drop frame.
- **3.3–5.5s (Reveal, slow-mo):** time ramps to **~30% speed**. As the light blooms down, the ****watch emerges**** rotating slowly from the core, suspended in a beam, shards drifting past in slow motion, a **tier-colored aura** (see below) radiating behind it. Caustics/refraction sparkle across the dial and crystal. Camera orbits ~30° around it.

- **5.5–8.0s (Savor + hero):** speed ramps back to normal; the watch settles into a clean **hero**

three-quarter shot, rim-lit, a slow specular glint travels across the crystal and bracelet; a soft particle shimmer settles; the GemBreak wordmark can fade in lower-third. Ends on a held, loop-ready frame.

Rarity aura (make this a swappable parameter) — the burst + aura color signals the tier so one rig serves all tiers: **Quartz** = cool white/silver · Emerald = green · Sapphire = deep blue · Diamond = prismatic rainbow caustics + gold sparks. Bigger tier = bigger burst, more particles, longer slow-mo.

Technical direction (Blender specifics)

- **Shatter:** Cell Fracture add-on on the gem → Rigid Body World, bake the explosion; add a Force Field (Explode/Wind) at the hit frame for the outward blast.
- **Particles:** one system for glass shards (instanced low-poly crystals), one for glowing energy sparks (emission, size-over-life), one for lingering dust (volumetric-lit).
- **Materials:** gem = Glass BSDF + volume absorption tinted to tier + strong IOR (~1.8) for caustics; watch = realistic metal/PBR (polished steel/gold), sapphire-crystal dial with clearcoat. Enable Cycles caustics (or bake fake caustics via projected light).
- **Lighting:** 3-point (key area light, cool rim, warm kicker) + an animated **burst light** that spikes to huge strength for ~3 frames at the hit; HDRI at low strength for reflections.
- **Camera:** 35–50mm, shallow **DOF** (racks focus from gem shell → watch dial on reveal), **motion blur ON**, subtle handheld noise via a constraint; the **speed ramp** via Time Remapping / the graph editor.
- **Compositor:** heavy **Bloom/Glare** (fog glow) on the hit, **lens distortion + chromatic aberration** pulse on the shockwave frame, slight film grain, a vignette, and a final **bloom bleed** on the watch glints.
- **Motion polish:** ease-in/ease-out on every camera move; the hit should be on a single sharp keyframe (no ease) so it snaps.

Sound cues (for the editor, so animation syncs to audio) — rising sub-drone through 0–3s → a sucking "silence" at the fake-out → a **massive bass drop + glass-shatter + choir/synth stab** on the hit frame → airy shimmer/reverb tail through the reveal. Every visual accent lands on a transient.

Deliverables: the master 7–9s clip + a **3s "hit-only" cut** (fake-out → HIT → reveal) for short-form, + an **alpha/transparent-background** render of the shatter and the watch beam so the editor can composite it over live pack-opening footage or any background.

PROMPT B — "Crystal Case Shatter Reveal" (the separate concept)

Create a **~6–8s, 9:16 vertical, 60fps** Blender animation. A luxury watch sits sealed inside a **solid** crystal/glass case **in a dark, premium void**. An invisible force strikes the case in escalating hits until it shatters, revealing the watch.

Beat sheet

- **0.0–1.5s:** the crystal watch case floats center-frame, slowly rotating, catching sharp rim light; caustics dance on the floor; the watch is visible but distorted through the thick refracting glass. Calm, expensive, quiet.
- **1.5–2.0s (Hit 1):** an **unseen impact** — the case jolts (sharp position/rotation snap + settle), a **single hairline crack** spiders across the front glass with a bright fracture-line flash; a few dust particles puff off; a low "tink." Camera micro-shake on impact.
- **2.5–3.0s (Hit 2):** **stronger jolt** — the case shakes harder, the crack **branches into a web**, a second and third fracture join it, a small chunk or two loosens, light leaks brighter from inside. Tension rising.
- **3.5–3.8s (Hit 3 — the shatter):** a **massive invisible blow** — the entire case **explodes** into glass, **shards flying outward toward camera** in slow-motion (~25–35% speed) with heavy motion blur,

refraction/caustics scattering rainbow light through every shard, a shockwave ring in the haze.

- **3.8–6.0s (Reveal, slow-mo):** as shards drift past and fall, the **watch is revealed** suspended in a light beam, rotating slowly, pristine, a tier-colored aura behind it, glints traveling across the dial.
- **6.0–8.0s (Hero + settle):** speed returns to normal, shards settle/dissolve, the watch lands in a clean hero shot, specular glint sweep, GemBreak wordmark optional, loop-ready end frame.

Technical direction (Blender specifics)

- **Progressive cracks:** don't fully fracture until Hit 3. For Hits 1–2, animate ****emissive crack decals / animated textures**** (or a growing "fracture line" mesh with an emission shader) across the glass surface so the cracks *spread* on cue. Use a **Build/mask or animated factor** to reveal the crack network over time.
- **The shatter:** **Cell Fracture** the case into ~150–400 shards (mix sizes; smaller near impact), pre-fractured but held together by Rigid Body Constraints; **break the constraints on Hit 3** and fire an **Explode/Force Field** from the impact point so glass flies toward camera. Bake the sim.
- **Invisible force:** sell it with **secondary motion** — the case's jolt (snap keyframes), a subtle air-distortion/heat-haze ripple at each impact (compositor lens/displace), and dust/particle puffs at the contact point. No visible object — the reaction *is* the force.
- **Glass material:** Glass BSDF, high IOR (~1.6–1.8), slight roughness variation, volume absorption for a faint tint; **Cycles caustics ON** (or projected fake caustics) so shards throw colored light. Dispersion (RGB IOR split) on the shatter shards = the rainbow-glass money shot.
- **Particles:** glass shards (instanced), glass dust/powder (fine, volumetric-lit), a few bright sparks on each hit, prismatic light motes on the shatter.
- **Camera:** slow push-in through Hits 1–2, then a **snap-and-orbit** on the shatter with racked focus onto the watch; **DOF + motion blur + speed ramp**; micro-shake keyed to each impact.
- **Compositor:** bloom/glare, chromatic aberration + lens distortion pulse on each hit (biggest on Hit 3), slight grain, vignette, and a prismatic dispersion glow on the flying shards.
- **Timing psychology:** escalate the interval and intensity — Hit 1 small, Hit 2 bigger and sooner-feeling, a **held beat of silence** right before Hit 3, then the shatter is the loudest single frame.

Sound cues: delicate "tink" on Hit 1 → heavier "crack + low thud" on Hit 2 → **held silence** → a **huge glass-shatter + bass drop + shimmer** on Hit 3 → airy reverb tail over the reveal.

Deliverables: master clip + a 3s short-form cut (Hit 2 → shatter → reveal) + ****alpha/transparent renders**** of the shattering glass and the watch beam for compositing over any footage. Provide the aura color as a swappable parameter so one file serves every pack tier.

Note for whoever runs this

Both are built to **composite over real pack-opening or creator-reaction footage** (alpha deliverables), so they slot straight into the clipping/AI-editor pipeline. Keep the **fake-out silence before the hit** and the **slow-mo savor after** — those two beats are what make it replayable; cutting them for time kills the dopamine.

PROMPT A2 — Matched to GemBreak's real flow (gamified + scale-safe)

★ USE THIS FOR PRODUCTION

Based on the actual reference stills: carousel of identical boxes → tap to select → box centers, gold keyhole glows → lid hinges open with a warm light shaft → watch rises out, backed by a tier-colored aura. Keep that simplicity. Add game-feel. Build it so ONE rig serves hundreds of watches without re-animating.

The elevated flow (keep it simple — 5–7s, 9:16, 60fps)

1. **Select (carousel):** the ring of boxes on the glossy floor. Add game-feel: the centered box gently

floats/bobs, its gold keyhole has a soft **breathing glow**, a subtle particle drift. "TAP TO OPEN."

1. **Charge-up (anticipation, ~0.6s)**: on tap, the keyhole **charges brighter**, the box does a small **shake/wind-up**, a **lock "click"** — light leaks from the seam. (This wind-up is the game-feel.)

1. **Open (the pop)**: lid **hinges open with a satisfying pop + overshoot** (ease-out then tiny settle), a **volumetric light shaft** blasts up out of the box, screen **bloom flash**.

1. **Tier tell (the gacha beat — optional but powerful)**: as the watch starts to rise, the ****aura color flickers/cycles for ~0.4s (white → green → blue...)** then locks** on the item's real tier color with a **snap + haptic + rarity banner** ("EMERALD" / tier name) sliding in. This is the single biggest dopamine add and it's pure UI, so it's cheap and scale-safe.

1. **Rise & spin (hero)**: the watch **floats up out of the box and slowly rotates**, tier aura glowing behind it, **sparkle/glimmer particles** rising, a specular glint sweeping the dial. Camera slow push-in.

1. **Settle**: watch holds in a clean hero pose, GemBreak wordmark optional, loop-ready end. High tiers get **more** (light rays, confetti, bigger shake); low tiers get a restrained version — all one parameter.

Game-feel checklist (tasteful, not busy): wind-up before payoff · overshoot/settle on the lid · a rarity-color LOCK moment · a rarity banner + haptic + sound sting · sparkle particles scaled by tier · subtle screen shake on open. That's it — resist adding more; the reference's restraint is a strength.

⚙️ Scale architecture — how it serves HUNDREDS of watches without breaking (the critical part)

The #1 rule: **the animation must never know or care which watch it is**. Decouple everything.

1. **Watch = a swappable slot, not part of the animation**. Build a single empty named **WATCH_SLOT** at a fixed transform inside the box. The box-open, light, aura, particles, and camera are ALL animated relative to the box/slot — **never keyframed to the watch mesh**. To add watch #427, you drop its model into **WATCH_SLOT**. Zero re-animation, ever.

1. **Auto-normalize every watch (this is what prevents breakage)**. Watches vary wildly in size/shape (a Casio vs a Rolex vs an AP). Add a **fit step** that scales + centers each watch to a ****target bounding box and sets a consistent pivot/origin**** (case center) and orientation (dial facing camera, +Z up). Enforce a **strict asset spec** for every incoming watch model:

- real-world scale, **origin at case center**, dial facing +Y, consistent axis convention
- poly budget + texture size caps (mobile), PBR set (base/rough/metal/normal), single material slot per part
- a **validation checklist / import script** that rejects or auto-corrects off-spec models.

Get this spec right once and 500 watches import clean; skip it and every 10th watch clips through the lid.

1. **Tier = one data value drives everything**. Aura color, light color, particle count, banner text, sound, and effect intensity all read from a single **tier** input (a ColorRamp/driver). One scene → all tiers. Never build per-tier scenes.

1. **Rendering at scale — pick the right path (do NOT pre-render one Blender video per watch)**:

- **Recommended — real-time in the app engine (Unity / Unreal / Three.js/R3F)**. Blender is used to **design + export** the box model, the lid-open animation, and the VFX look; the watch model loads at **runtime** into the slot; the shader/particle reveal plays live. Infinitely scalable, and the app already renders 3D. This is almost certainly how IcyBox does it.

- **If you must pre-render in Blender**: build ONE **template scene** (box + open anim + aura + camera + **WATCH_SLOT**) and a **Python batch script** that, per watch: imports the model → runs the auto-fit → sets the tier params → renders. Or cheaper: render the **box-open + aura as an alpha template ONCE**, then composite each watch's turntable into the slot in the editor. Never hand-animate per watch.

1. **Performance budget (mobile)**: cap watch poly/texture counts, use LODs, bake what you can, keep the particle/volume cost fixed regardless of tier (scale visually via emission/color, not sim complexity) so frame-time is constant across all hundreds of items.

One-line rule for the animator: *build the box, the light, the aura, and the camera as a fixed, watch-agnostic rig with a normalized `WATCH_SLOT` and a single `tier` parameter — then any watch, at any tier, "just works" by dropping the model in. If adding a new watch ever requires touching the animation, the rig is wrong.*